



Makerspaces do bring in more men than women.
This Shibori dyeing workshop brought a refreshing change in members

So now, while production of goods was concentrated in the hands of a few; feedback on usage, quality and features was being communicated back to big brands by the consumers. Out of nowhere, big companies were looking at mammoth amounts of data like they had never seen before. Communicating with users one-on-one was possible and dynamic brands were eager to use this insight to better their offerings. By this time, most companies had embraced the digital revolution, Indian families jumped on board to educate their children to grow up to operate in software-related job profiles for the barrage of work opportunities that it promised and delivered on a decade later. It is fair to note that these well-meaning parents were not wrong; there is still no short supply of job openings for software engineers the world over.

There was also a cultural movement brewing when hackathons took place in European cities; Germany is credited for being the first though adequate documentation isn't available. Here, groups of young programmers were developing a sense of community and gathering to combine their prowess with technology for a common cause. They didn't start off saving the world; they started out with the premise of sharing knowledge, making electronic art and other such transient intentions. What they managed however was to create a sense of community, open sharing and goodwill.

But getting back to business and how computer-integrated manufacturing software was also available to those unsatisfied consumers to tweak, bend and create better versions of products they wanted to see in the open market. Then came additive manufacturing which acted as the game changer though, it is imperative to note that none of this would have been possible without the first few players involved. The 3D printer, here, is king. It allowed for computer generated digital files to feed into a machine that used mate-